

Saraswati Pooja

A Speech for Every Level of English

This collection presents six versions of the same devotional speech on the festival of **Saraswati Pooja** — written to be delivered before a large audience at the pooja venue.

Five versions are graded across the CEFR scale (**A1** → **C1**), with level-appropriate vocabulary highlighted in **red, bold & italic**. A sixth **Bonus Edition** is packed with everyday **phrasal verbs**, highlighted in green bold.

Each speech follows an Introduction – Body – Conclusion structure, and is followed by a glossary of the highlighted words with their English and Hindi meanings (Hindi given in Roman-script transliteration), plus a word count.

1.	A1 - Beginner	268 words
2.	A2 - Elementary	270 words
3.	B1 - Intermediate	302 words
4.	B2 - Upper-Intermediate	298 words
5.	C1 - Advanced	301 words
6.	Bonus - Maximum Phrasal Verbs Edition	298 words

VERSION 1 | CEFR LEVEL: A1 – Beginner

INTRODUCTION

Good morning to all the teachers, parents, and my dear friends. Today is a very special day. We **celebrate** Saraswati Pooja. Saraswati is a **goddess**. She is the goddess of **knowledge** and music. We love and **respect** her very much.

BODY

Every year, we celebrate this pooja with great joy. In the morning, we take a bath and wear new clothes. We come to this pooja place with flowers, fruits, and sweets. We also bring our books and pens. We keep them near the goddess. This is a very old **tradition**. We do this to get her **blessings**.

Saraswati Pooja is very important for students like us. We study every day. We want to be good students. Saraswati gives us knowledge. She helps us to read and write well. She helps us to understand many things. Without knowledge, life is very hard. So, we thank Saraswati today.

Music is also a big part of this **festival**. We sing songs and play music. Many people dance too. Children are very **cheerful** on this day. They wear new clothes and eat good food. Friends and family come together. Everyone is happy.

We also learn good **values** on this day. We learn to respect our teachers. We learn to respect our books. We learn to work hard. These are important lessons for all of us.

CONCLUSION

Dear friends, let us pray to Goddess Saraswati today. Let us ask for her blessings. Let us **promise** to study well. Let us promise to be good people. I am very happy to be here with you today. Thank you very much. Happy Saraswati Pooja to everyone!

Word Count: 268 words

CEFR (A1) Vocabulary - English & Hindi Meanings

Word / Phrase	English Meaning	Hindi Meaning (Roman Script)
celebrate	to observe an event with joy	Mananaa
goddess	a female god	Devi
knowledge	information and understanding	Gyaan
respect	a feeling of honour for someone	Sammaan
tradition	an old custom passed on	Parampara
blessings	kind wishes from God/elders	Aashirwaad
festival	a day of celebration	Tyohaar
cheerful	happy and full of joy	Prasann

Word / Phrase	English Meaning	Hindi Meaning (Roman Script)
values	good beliefs and principles	Mulya
promise	to say you will surely do something	Vaada

VERSION 2 | CEFR LEVEL: A2 – Elementary

INTRODUCTION

Respected teachers, dear parents, and my wonderful friends, good morning to all of you. Today we have **gathered** here to celebrate Saraswati Pooja, one of the most beautiful festivals of our culture. Goddess Saraswati is worshipped as the **deity** of knowledge, **wisdom**, music, and arts.

BODY

Every year, on this **auspicious** day, students and families come together to seek her blessings. Early in the morning, we clean our homes and **decorate** the pooja place with flowers and colourful rangoli. We place our books, pens, and musical instruments near the idol of the goddess, because we believe she blesses everything related to learning.

This festival teaches us an important lesson: knowledge is the greatest gift in life. Without proper education, it becomes difficult to achieve our goals or understand the world around us. That is why students specially pray to Saraswati before examinations, hoping for **concentration**, confidence, and success.

Apart from prayers, this day is also filled with cultural programmes. Children sing devotional songs, recite poems, and perform traditional dances. Elders share interesting stories about the **significance** of the festival, which helps younger generations understand our **heritage** better.

Saraswati Pooja also encourages us to develop good habits such as **discipline**, **sincerity**, and **gratitude**. We learn to be thankful for our teachers, our schools, and every opportunity we get to learn something new.

CONCLUSION

Dear friends, as we celebrate this wonderful occasion together, let us take a moment to thank Goddess Saraswati for her endless blessings. Let us promise to study sincerely and use our knowledge for good purposes. Thank you so much, and I wish everyone a very happy and blessed Saraswati Pooja!

Word Count: 270 words

CEFR (A2) Vocabulary - English & Hindi Meanings

Word / Phrase	English Meaning	Hindi Meaning (Roman Script)
gathered	came together in a group	Ekatra hue
deity	a god or goddess	Devta
wisdom	deep understanding and good judgement	Buddhi
auspicious	bringing good luck; favourable	Shubh
decorate	to make something beautiful	Sajaanaa
concentration	focused attention on one thing	Ekaagrataa

Word / Phrase	English Meaning	Hindi Meaning (Roman Script)
significance	the importance or meaning of something	Mahatva
heritage	traditions passed down from the past	Viraasat
discipline	controlled and orderly behaviour	Anushaasan
sincerity	honesty of feeling and intention	Imaandaari
gratitude	feeling thankful	Kritagyataa

VERSION 3 | CEFR LEVEL: B1 – Intermediate

INTRODUCTION

Respected dignitaries, honourable teachers, loving parents, and my dear fellow students, a very warm good morning to each one of you. It is truly a privilege to stand before you on this joyous occasion of Saraswati Pooja, a festival that holds immense significance in Indian culture and tradition.

BODY

Goddess Saraswati is **revered** as the **embodiment** of knowledge, wisdom, music, and the fine arts. She symbolises the pursuit of learning in its purest form. On this sacred day, we gather not merely to perform rituals, but to reflect upon the true value of education in shaping our character and future.

Traditionally, we adorn the pooja venue with flowers, install the idol with great reverence, and place our academic materials before her, believing that this act enhances our **intellect** and creativity. Students, in particular, approach this festival with heartfelt devotion, praying for clarity of thought and academic excellence.

However, Saraswati Pooja is not confined to rituals alone; it inspires us to **cultivate** humility, **perseverance**, and a genuine thirst for knowledge. In today's competitive world, where information is abundant but wisdom is rare, this festival reminds us to seek understanding rather than mere information.

The cultural programmes organised on this occasion, including devotional songs, classical dance performances, and recitations, help preserve our rich heritage and pass it on to younger generations. These activities foster a sense of unity and cultural pride among the community. Moreover, this festival encourages gratitude towards our **mentors** and educators, who play an **indispensable** role in nurturing our intellect.

CONCLUSION

Let us therefore utilise this occasion to renew our commitment towards **diligent** study and ethical conduct. In conclusion, dear friends, let us seek Goddess Saraswati's blessings with sincere hearts and **resolve** to apply our knowledge for the betterment of society. Wishing you all a truly **enlightening** and prosperous Saraswati Pooja. Thank you.

Word Count: 302 words

CEFR (B1) Vocabulary - English & Hindi Meanings

Word / Phrase	English Meaning	Hindi Meaning (Roman Script)
revered	deeply respected and admired	Poojneeey
embodiment	a perfect example of a quality	Pratiroop
intellect	the ability to think and reason	Buddhi

Word / Phrase	English Meaning	Hindi Meaning (Roman Script)
<i>cultivate</i>	to develop or improve something	Vikasit karnaa
<i>perseverance</i>	steady effort despite difficulty	Dridhataa
<i>mentors</i>	trusted guides or teachers	Maargdarshak
<i>indispensable</i>	absolutely necessary	Anivaarya
<i>diligent</i>	careful and hard-working	Parishrami
<i>resolve</i>	a firm decision to do something	Sankalp
<i>enlightening</i>	giving new knowledge or understanding	Gyaanvardhak

VERSION 4 | CEFR LEVEL: B2 – Upper-Intermediate

INTRODUCTION

Respected elders, esteemed teachers, and my dear friends assembled here today, I extend my heartfelt greetings on this auspicious occasion of Saraswati Pooja. This festival **transcends** the boundaries of mere ritualistic observance; it embodies a profound philosophical reflection on the nature of knowledge itself.

BODY

Goddess Saraswati, often depicted with a veena, a book, and a swan, represents the harmonious integration of art, intellect, and **discernment**. Each symbol associated with her carries a deeper **connotation** — the swan signifies the ability to distinguish between right and wrong, while the book represents the perpetual quest for wisdom.

As we **congregate** here today, adorned in traditional attire and surrounded by an atmosphere of devotion, it is worth contemplating why this festival resonates so deeply within our collective consciousness. In an era characterised by information overload, where knowledge is often reduced to superficial data, Saraswati Pooja compels us to **introspect** and rediscover the essence of genuine learning — one that nurtures wisdom, empathy, and ethical judgement.

The rituals performed today, from the invocation of the deity to the offering of books and instruments, are not **vestiges** of blind superstition but rather symbolic gestures that reaffirm our reverence for education. Furthermore, the cultural performances that accompany this celebration serve as a **conduit** for preserving our artistic heritage, fostering intergenerational continuity.

It is **imperative** that we, as beneficiaries of this rich tradition, internalise its underlying message: that true knowledge liberates, empowers, and elevates the human spirit. Let this festival serve as a **catalyst** for renewed dedication towards intellectual growth and moral integrity.

CONCLUSION

In conclusion, may Goddess Saraswati bestow upon us clarity of thought, depth of understanding, and the wisdom to **discern** truth amidst complexity. I extend my sincere wishes for a truly enlightening and spiritually enriching Saraswati Pooja to all present here. Thank you.

Word Count: 298 words

CEFR (B2) Vocabulary - English & Hindi Meanings

Word / Phrase	English Meaning	Hindi Meaning (Roman Script)
transcends	goes beyond the usual limits	Se pare jaana
discernment	keen insight and good judgement	Vivek
connotation	an implied or associated meaning	Bhaavaarth
congregate	to gather together in a crowd	Ekatra honaa
introspect	to examine one's own thoughts	Aatm-nireekshan karnaa

Word / Phrase	English Meaning	Hindi Meaning (Roman Script)
vestiges	small remaining traces of something	Avshesh
conduit	a channel through which something passes	Maadhyam
imperative	extremely important; essential	Avashyak
catalyst	something that causes change or action	Utprerak
discern	to recognise or understand clearly	Pehchaannaa

VERSION 5 | CEFR LEVEL: C1 – Advanced

INTRODUCTION

Distinguished guests, revered teachers, and cherished friends gathered here this morning, it is with profound reverence that I stand before you to commemorate the auspicious festival of Saraswati Pooja. This occasion, far from being a mere ceremonial ritual, **epitomises** humanity's timeless reverence for knowledge as an **emancipatory** force.

BODY

Goddess Saraswati, the **quintessential** embodiment of wisdom, artistry, and **eloquence**, invites us to contemplate the intrinsic relationship between intellectual cultivation and spiritual fulfilment. Her iconography — the veena symbolising harmony, the manuscript denoting perpetual learning, and the swan epitomising discernment — offers a rich **allegorical** framework through which we may examine our own pursuit of enlightenment.

In contemporary society, inundated with superficial information and ephemeral distractions, this festival serves as a poignant reminder to cultivate discernment over mere accumulation of facts. True **erudition**, as this tradition suggests, is not measured by the volume of information one possesses, but by one's capacity to synthesise, interpret, and apply knowledge **judiciously** for the collective good.

The rituals we observe today — invoking the deity, consecrating our academic instruments, and partaking in devotional music — are imbued with symbolic resonance, reaffirming our commitment to intellectual and moral **rectitude**. Moreover, the accompanying cultural performances serve as a vital conduit through which our artistic heritage is transmitted across generations, fostering continuity amid an ever-evolving world.

It **behoves** us, therefore, to internalise the deeper philosophical underpinnings of this celebration: that knowledge, when tempered with humility and ethical discernment, becomes a transformative and emancipatory force. Let this auspicious occasion **galvanise** within us a renewed commitment to scholarly rigour, intellectual integrity, and compassionate wisdom.

CONCLUSION

In conclusion, may Goddess Saraswati illuminate our intellects, refine our sensibilities, and guide us towards a life of purposeful learning. I extend my heartfelt wishes for a deeply enriching and enlightening Saraswati Pooja to everyone present. Thank you.

Word Count: 301 words

CEFR (C1) Vocabulary - English & Hindi Meanings

Word / Phrase	English Meaning	Hindi Meaning (Roman Script)
epitomises	is a perfect example of	Ka prateek hai
emancipatory	freeing someone from restriction	Muktidaayak
quintessential	representing the most perfect example	Sarvotkrisht

Word / Phrase	English Meaning	Hindi Meaning (Roman Script)
<i>eloquence</i>	fluent and persuasive speech	Vaakpatutaa
<i>allegorical</i>	using symbolic representation	Roopakaatmak
<i>erudition</i>	extensive knowledge from study	Vidvattaa
<i>judiciously</i>	with sound and careful judgement	Vivekpurn dhang se
<i>rectitude</i>	moral correctness and integrity	Sadaachaar
<i>behoves</i>	is necessary or proper for	Uchit honaa
<i>galvanise</i>	to stir into sudden action	Prerit karnaa

BONUS VERSION | Maximum Phrasal Verbs Edition

INTRODUCTION

Good morning everyone. I would like to **kick off** today's speech by welcoming all of you who have **turned up** for this wonderful celebration of Saraswati Pooja.

BODY

Every year, when this festival **comes around**, our whole community **comes together** to **carry out** the traditional rituals with great devotion. Families **wake up** early, **dress up** in new clothes, and **set off** for the pooja pandal with flowers and offerings.

Goddess Saraswati has been **looked up to** for centuries as the giver of knowledge and wisdom. Students, especially, **look forward to** this day because they believe that praying to her helps them to **take in** new lessons more easily and do well in their exams.

Before the pooja begins, we make sure to **lay out** our books and musical instruments in front of the idol. Elders in the family often **bring up** old stories about the festival, and it is heart-warming to see how younger children **sit down** to listen and **soak up** every word.

Throughout the day, cultural programmes are **put on**, where students **sing along** to devotional songs and **act out** little skits about the goddess. This helps to **pass on** our traditions to the next generation and keeps our culture from **dying out**.

As the pooja **draws to a close**, we **hand out** sweets, called prasad, to everyone present. Before we **wrap up** the celebrations, let us not forget to thank our teachers, who help us to **grow up** into knowledgeable and responsible individuals.

CONCLUSION

So, let us all **join in**, pray sincerely, and vow to **keep up** our efforts to learn something new every single day. I hope this festival brings us closer together and **lifts up** our spirits. Thank you very much, and I **look forward to** celebrating many more Saraswati Poojas with all of you!

Word Count: 298 words

Phrasal Verbs Used (English & Hindi Meanings)

Word / Phrase	English Meaning	Hindi Meaning (Roman Script)
kick off	to begin or start	Shuru karnaa
turn up	to arrive at a place	Aa pahunchnaa
come around	to happen again, as in a cycle	Phir se aanaa
come together	to unite; to join as a group	Ek saath aanaa
carry out	to perform or complete a task	Poora karnaa
wake up	to stop sleeping	Jaagna
dress up	to wear special/nice clothes	Saj-dhaj kar taiyaar honaa

Word / Phrase	English Meaning	Hindi Meaning (Roman Script)
set off	to start a journey	Yatra shuru karnaa
look up to	to admire and respect someone	Aadar karnaa
look forward to	to feel excited about something coming	Prateeksha karnaa
take in	to absorb and understand information	Samajhnaa
lay out	to arrange things neatly	Vyavasthit rakhnaa
bring up	to mention or introduce a topic	Baat chhednaa
sit down	to take a seated position	Baith jaanaa
soak up	to absorb something eagerly	Avshoshit karnaa
put on	to organise and present a show	Prastut karnaa
sing along	to sing together with others/music	Saath mein gaanaa
act out	to perform a story through actions	Abhinay karnaa
pass on	to hand something down to others	Aage badhaanaa
die out	to gradually disappear	Lupt ho jaanaa
draw to a close	to come near the end	Samaapti ki or badhnaa
hand out	to distribute something to people	Baantnaa
wrap up	to finish or conclude something	Samaapt karnaa
grow up	to become an adult; to mature	Bada honaa
join in	to take part in an activity	Shaamil honaa
keep up	to continue at the same pace/effort	Jaari rakhnaa
lift up	to raise or improve spirits	Utsaahit karnaa